



bazaar

GTX 275

has been launched in India by XFX

XFX ATI RADEON HD 4890

From Green to Red

The time has finally come for XFX, a company that used to manufacture only NVIDIA solutions, and has now moved onto ATI graphic cards. XFX has launched ATI's HD 4000 series, and we have with us the new high-end ATI Radeon HD 4890 graphics card.

XFX has followed ATI's reference design in terms of the cooling solution for this card. One thing to note is that ATI has not moved to a 40 nm GPU, but stuck with the 55 nm GPU, the same used on the HD 4870. This card has 800 stream processors, the same as the HD 4870, with a core and memory speed of 850 MHz and 3,900 MHz, which is faster than the HD 4870. There are two 6-pin power connectors for this card, but it is lacking an HDMI port. XFX has provided a DVI-to-HDMI converter, but an HDMI port would have been much appreciated.

On our test setup consisting of an Intel QX9650 @ 3.0 GHz, 4 GB DDR2 memory running at 1,066 MHz and a Windows Vista operating system, 3D Mark Vantage gave us a score of 10,668 under performance mode and a GPU score of 10,220, which is quite a good score. The XFX Radeon HD 4890 is ATI's newest entry. In all reality it's a tweaked up



version of the HD 4870. It does not stand a chance against the GTX 285 or GTX 295 from NVIDIA, but it definitely performs better than the 4870. If you really want a high-end card, but want to spend less than on the 4870, this is the card for you.

Specifications:

Bus Type PCIe 2.0, GPU Clock: 850 MHz, Memory Bus: 256-bit, Memory Size: 1024 MB DDR5, Memory Speed: 3900 MHz

Ratings

Features: 8
Performance: 8
Build quality: 8
Value for money: 9
Overall: 8

Contact: Rashi Peripherals Pvt. Ltd.
Phone: +91-22-6709 0828
Email: response@rptechindia.com
Web site: www.rptechindia.com
Price: Rs. 19,999

WD HD player

Have an HDTV? Buy this now!

Even though the boom in LCD and Plasma TVs is great news for everyone, broadcasting of HD content still hasn't taken off. This means that people have to depend on Blu-ray disks and their movie databases to make good sense of their expensive purchases of LCDs and Plasmas.

The only way out is to the setup an HTPC for HD. However, Western Digital might have something of interest. Diversifying from its main hard drive business, it has created a compact little player

called the WD TV HD Player, which plays every format you can think of — well almost every format we could think of.

The user-interface on the player is clean and designed very professionally and is extremely easy to use. The remote has all the controls required to run the device. The remote isn't chunky but is light and flat, but it doesn't feel so great in the palm of your hand.

The performance of the player is very good. It provides good quality audio and video. We tried all kinds of media dumped on an external portable storage drive from WD as well as a few flash drives. However, the movies encoded with digital audio had problems decoding. These have to be connected using the optical out to a receiver.

Making this player has been a great move by WD and it removes the need for an HTPC solely for playing back HD videos. An HTPC is a nice thing to have, but then there's the trouble of getting a compact

case, setting up all the hardware and software. Sure, you get all the flexibility you need to run whatever you want — games, movies, music, photos, browse the net, chat, etc. On the other hand, many of us just want music, photo viewing and videos on our TV. If you're like us, then we honestly think this player a must-have for its price which isn't very high for the performance and format support.

Specifications:

2 USB ports, Display interface: HDMI, Composite A/V, Dimensions: 40 x 100 x 125.5 mm, Weight: 303 g

Ratings

Features: 8
Performance: 9
Build quality: 7.5
Value for money: 7
Overall: 8

Contact: Amarjeet Singh
Phone: +91-93210 29204
Email: amarjeet.singh@wdc.com
Web site: www.wdc.com
Price: Rs. 8,500



TRIED & TESTED